were waiting for confirmation. We decided to tell Amala in the morning, as it would have been the wee hours of the night in Singapore. The news had been in the pipeline for so long that it didn't seem that big a surprise when it actually happened. We were inundated with calls and congratulatory messages. People seemed genuinely pleased to have us (at the helm). Significant among the calls was one from Kalpana, Gen Ranbir Singh's wife, as Gen Ranbir was also in the running for the same position. I spoke to our old buddy Hav Gurnam. He had done a lot for us during the years that the girls were growing up. So also Harjit (another buddy, retired) who was pleased to hear the news. It was particularly gratifying to receive messages from younger officers and their wives, who had been with us at Ambala, Delhi, Shimla and Kolkata, as well as various tenures before that.

Amala was in Singapore and came to know only the next morning.

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In Amala's words:

My phone alarm jolted me awake. Bleary-eyed, I turned to switch it off. It was 6.45 a.m. Singapore time. Twenty-five WhatsApp messages and three missed calls. What?! I shot up in bed, all sleep forgotten. Had something bad happened? Thankfully, it was happy news. It turned out that my dad had been confirmed as the twenty-eighth Chief of Army Staff the previous night. As Singapore is a few hours ahead of India, I was already in bed and fast asleep before the news could reach me. In the days that followed, I was astounded at the number of people who came up to me to congratulate me and our family on the news. Living in Singapore, I assumed that not many people in my circle would follow the news closely enough or understand its enormity. But I was mistaken. I was heartened